

Stylist App — Build Context & Decisions

What we are building

An AI-powered personal styling web app for women. The MVP has two core flows only:

1. **Onboarding quiz** — a multi-step questionnaire capturing colour season, body proportions, contrast level, face shape, and feature scale. Claude API generates a personalised style profile with practical rules at the end.
2. **Photo verdict** — user uploads a photo of a garment. The app sends the image + their style profile to Claude API and returns a Yes / No / With Adjustments verdict with a brief explanation.

That is the complete MVP. Nothing else is in scope.

North Star principle

Return to this whenever a new feature idea enters the conversation. If it does not serve the woman who wants to understand and act on what suits her — it waits.

All confirmed decisions

Platform

- Web-first MVP — testers access via a browser link, no App Store or install required
- iOS via TestFlight comes after web MVP is validated
- One codebase for both (React Native + Expo)

Tech stack

- Framework: React Native + Expo
- Deployment: Web build, hosted (Vercel or equivalent)
- AI: Claude API, model claude-sonnet-4-6
- Backend: Lightweight serverless proxy to hold API key server-side (never client-side)

Authentication

- Anonymous session first — zero friction, profile lives in local storage
- After quiz completion, prompt user to save profile with Sign in with Apple
- No email/password, no Google auth in MVP
- Backend sync only needed when user signs in — flag what's needed when we get there

API key security

- Claude API key must never be exposed client-side
- A serverless backend proxy is required from day one — this is non-negotiable even for MVP
- Cowork should architect this correctly before any AI calls are wired up

Visual design

- Mood: calm, intelligent, highly functional — competence and self-discovery, not trend-chasing
- Feel: premium tool, expedition notebook, structured information
- Typography: clean, purposeful, modern — not decorative
- Colour: neutral base, one considered accent — cool, precise, confident. No warm or chalky tones.
- No gradients, no excessive animation, no Instagram-style cards
- Generous whitespace, clear visual hierarchy, every element earns its place

Colour analysis standard

- Sci/ART 12-season colour system
- Primary season + specific borrowing colours from adjacent seasons with reasoning

How I want Cowork to work with me

- I have no development background — explain everything in plain English
- Think three steps ahead before suggesting any approach
- Flag security risks, cost implications, and architectural dead ends proactively — even if I haven't asked
- Break the build into clear phases, tell me what we're doing and why that order
- Always tell me what file we're working on and where it sits in the project structure
- Explain what code does in one sentence before showing it
- If there are two ways to do something, give me the tradeoffs and recommend one
- Never let me paint myself into a corner

What the app is NOT (hard boundaries)

- Not a digital closet or wardrobe management tool
- No social features, following, or outfit feeds

- No affiliate links or shopping connections in MVP
- No male styling in V1
- No sustainability or ethical sourcing scores
- No price filtering
- No human stylists

Open questions to revisit later

- Weighted scoring model for quiz profile determination
- Tone and boundaries for the app's advice voice
- How to communicate photo colour accuracy limitations to users (lighting, white balance unreliability)
- Success metrics definition